

संभव Batch

Static GK: Festivals of India — Answer Key & Explanations

Under guidance: Vipulendra Tripathi Sir

Note: Options (A, B, C, D) vary by generation. The absolute **Key Facts** and detailed **Explanations** are provided below with 100% accuracy.

Part 1: Match the Following (Q1 - Q13)

Q1. Fact / Answer: Bihu (Assam), Pongal (Tamil Nadu), Onam (Kerala), Lohri (Punjab)

Explanation: These are major harvest festivals. Bihu is central to Assamese culture, Pongal is a 4-day festival in Tamil Nadu, Onam celebrates the harvest in Kerala, and Lohri is a prominent winter harvest festival in Punjab.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2021

Q2. Fact / Answer: Ambubachi (Assam), Moatsu (Nagaland), Sarhul (Jharkhand), Nuakhai (Odisha)

Explanation: Ambubachi Mela happens at Kamakhya Temple (Assam). Moatsu is celebrated by the Ao tribe in Nagaland. Sarhul is the tribal spring festival of Jharkhand. Nuakhai is an agricultural festival of Western Odisha.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2022

Q3. Fact / Answer: Hemis (Ladakh), Losar (Arunachal Pradesh), Saga Dawa (Sikkim), Hornbill (Nagaland)

Explanation: Hemis is a major Buddhist festival in Ladakh. Losar is celebrated by the Monpa tribe in Arunachal (also in Ladakh/Sikkim). Saga Dawa is the holiest Tibetan Buddhist festival in Sikkim. Hornbill is the 'Festival of Festivals' in Nagaland.

EXAM: SSC CHSL 2021

Q4. Fact / Answer: Tarnetar (Gujarat), Pushkar (Rajasthan), Sonapur (Bihar), Surajkund (Haryana)

Explanation: Tarnetar is a famous fair in Gujarat. Pushkar is a camel fair in Rajasthan. Sonapur is Asia's largest cattle fair in Bihar. Surajkund is an international crafts mela in Haryana.

EXAM: SSC CGL TIER-II 2020

Q5. Fact / Answer: Gudi Padwa (Maharashtra), Ugadi (Karnataka), Vishu (Kerala), Puthandu (Tamil Nadu)

Explanation: These represent the traditional regional New Year festivals according to the lunisolar/solar calendars in their respective states.

EXAM: SSC MTS 2022

Q6. Fact / Answer: Bathukamma (Telangana), Thrissur Pooram (Kerala), Natyanjali (Tamil Nadu), Hampi (Karnataka)

Explanation: Bathukamma is a floral festival in Telangana. Thrissur Pooram is famous for caparisoned elephants in Kerala. Natyanjali is an annual dance festival dedicated to Lord Shiva in TN. Hampi festival celebrates the Vijayanagara empire in Karnataka.

EXAM: SSC CPO 2020

Q7. Fact / Answer: Cherry Blossom (Meghalaya), Shirui Lily (Manipur), Anthurium (Mizoram), Sangai (Manipur)

Explanation: Cherry Blossom is unique to Shillong, Meghalaya. Shirui Lily and Sangai (named after the state deer) are major tourism festivals in Manipur. Anthurium promotes tourism and flower cultivation in Mizoram.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2023

Q8. Fact / Answer: Madhavpur (Gujarat), Bali Jatra (Odisha), Gangaur (Rajasthan), Minjar (Himachal Pradesh)

Explanation: Madhavpur Mela celebrates Lord Krishna's marriage to Rukmini in Gujarat. Bali Jatra commemorates Odisha's maritime history. Gangaur honors Goddess Gauri in Rajasthan. Minjar is a maize harvest festival in HP.

EXAM: SSC CHSL 2022

Q9. Fact / Answer: Rongali (Spring), Kongali (Autumn), Bhogali (Winter), Ali-Aye-Ligang (Mising Tribe)

Explanation: The three Bihus of Assam are Rongali (Spring New Year), Kongali (Autumn/Lamps), and Bhogali (Winter/Harvest). Ali-Aye-Ligang is an agriculture festival of the Mising tribe.

EXAM: SSC CGL TIER-II 2022

Q10. Fact / Answer: Attukal Pongala (Kerala), Chhath (Bihar), Karma (Jharkhand), Bhagoriya (Madhya Pradesh)

Explanation: Attukal Pongala holds the Guinness record for the largest gathering of women. Chhath is dedicated to the Sun God. Karma involves tree worship in Jharkhand/Bihar. Bhagoriya is a tribal festival in MP.

EXAM: SSC MTS 2021

Q11. Fact / Answer: Nongkrem (Khasi), Behdienkhlam (Jaintia), Yaoshang (Manipur Holi), Cheiraoba (Manipur New Year)

Explanation: Nongkrem is a Khasi thanksgiving festival. Behdienkhlam is the most important Jaintia festival. Yaoshang is celebrated like Holi in Manipur, and Cheiraoba is the traditional Meitei New Year.

EXAM: SSC CPO 2022

Q12. Fact / Answer: Sekrenyi (Angami), Tuluni (Sumi), Aoling (Konyak), Tokhu Emong (Lotha)

Explanation: These are distinct tribal festivals of Nagaland. Sekrenyi is a purification festival of the Angamis. Tuluni is celebrated by Sumis. Aoling by Konyaks (headhunters). Tokhu Emong is the post-harvest festival of the Lothas.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2021

Q13. Fact / Answer: Makaravilakku (Kerala), Jallikattu (Tamil Nadu), Kambala (Karnataka), Medaram Jatara (Telangana)

Explanation: Makaravilakku is held at Sabarimala. Jallikattu is a traditional bull-taming sport. Kambala is a buffalo race in Karnataka's muddy fields. Medaram Jatara is a massive tribal gathering in Telangana.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2020

Part 2: Assertion-Reason (Q14 - Q26)**Q14. Fact / Answer: Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).**

Explanation: Ambubachi Mela is an annual Hindu mela held at Kamakhya Temple in Guwahati, Assam. It celebrates the yearly menstruation course of Goddess Kamakhya.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2022

Q15. Fact / Answer: Assertion (A) is true, but Reason (R) is false.

Explanation: While the Hornbill festival is known as the 'Festival of Festivals', the reason is false because it is organized in Nagaland (not Meghalaya) to encourage inter-tribal interaction.

EXAM: SSC CHSL 2021

Q16. Fact / Answer: Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

Explanation: Makar Sankranti signifies the sun's transition into Capricorn (Makara). Because of India's diversity, it is celebrated as Pongal, Uttarayan, Magh Bihu, etc.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2020

Q17. Fact / Answer: Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

Explanation: Jallikattu is typically practiced in Tamil Nadu as a part of Pongal celebrations on the Mattu Pongal day, honoring the cattle that help in farming.

EXAM: SSC CPO 2022

Q18. Fact / Answer: Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

Explanation: Kumbh Mela rotates among four holy sites: Prayagraj (confluence of Ganga, Yamuna, mythical Saraswati), Haridwar (Ganga), Ujjain (Shipra), and Nashik (Godavari).

EXAM: SSC CGL TIER-II 2021

Q19. Fact / Answer: Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

Explanation: Nuakhai is a major agrarian festival in Odisha. 'Nua' means new and 'Khai' means food, celebrating the newly harvested rice.

EXAM: SSC MTS 2022

Q20. Fact / Answer: Assertion (A) is false, but Reason (R) is true.

Explanation: Losar marks the Tibetan New Year. However, the assertion is false because it is NOT exclusively celebrated in Ladakh; it is also heavily celebrated in Arunachal Pradesh, Sikkim, and Himachal Pradesh.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2023

Q21. Fact / Answer: Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

Explanation: Chhath Puja is an ancient Vedic festival historically native to Bihar, Jharkhand, and UP, purely dedicated to Surya (Sun God) and Chhathi Maiya to thank them for life.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2021

Q22. Fact / Answer: Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

Explanation: Sarhul means 'Worship of Trees'. Tribes like Munda, Oraon, and Ho in Jharkhand celebrate the blooming of the Sal tree, marking the beginning of their new year.

EXAM: SSC CHSL 2020

Q23. Fact / Answer: Assertion (A) is true, but Reason (R) is false.

Explanation: Thaipusam is indeed a major Tamil Hindu festival, but it is primarily dedicated to Lord Murugan (Kartikeya), the son of Shiva, not Lord Shiva himself.

EXAM: SSC CPO 2021

Q24. Fact / Answer: Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

Explanation: Wangala is a post-harvest festival of the Garo tribe in Meghalaya. It is called the '100 Drums Festival' because 100 drummers play simultaneously during the celebration.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2022

Q25. Fact / Answer: Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

Explanation: Kharchi Puja is a prominent festival of Tripura where 14 dynastic gods are worshipped. It involves cleaning the deities in a holy river.

EXAM: SSC MTS 2020

Q26. Fact / Answer: Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

Explanation: Sangai Festival promotes Manipur as a world-class tourism destination. It is aptly named after the Sangai, the rare brow-antlered deer found only in Manipur.

EXAM: SSC CGL TIER-II 2022

Part 3: Multiple Statements (Q27 - Q38)

Q27. Fact / Answer: 1 and 2 only

Explanation: Statement 3 is incorrect. The Haridwar Kumbh Mela is held on the banks of the river Ganga, not Yamuna. Ujjain is on Shipra, Nashik on Godavari, and Prayagraj at the confluence.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2022

Q28. Fact / Answer: 1, 2, and 3

Explanation: All statements are correct. Bohag (Rongali) is Spring/New Year. Kati (Kongali) is an animistic festival of lighting lamps (Akash Banti). Magh (Bhogali) is the winter harvest festival.

EXAM: SSC CHSL 2021

Q29. Fact / Answer: 1, 2, and 3

Explanation: All statements are correct regarding Onam. It welcomes King Mahabali, features the famous Vallam Kali (snake boat race), and women create intricate Pookkalams (floral carpets).

EXAM: SSC CPO 2022

Q30. Fact / Answer: 1 and 2 only

Explanation: Statement 3 is incorrect. The massive chariots for the deities (Jagannath, Balabhadra, Subhadra) in Puri, Odisha are traditionally constructed entirely out of wood (specifically Neem wood), not metal.

EXAM: SSC CGL TIER-II 2021

Q31. Fact / Answer: 1, 2, and 3

Explanation: All statements are true. Durga Puja is West Bengal's major festival celebrating the Goddess's victory over Mahishasura. In 2021, UNESCO inscribed it on the Intangible Cultural Heritage list.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2023

Q32. Fact / Answer: 1 and 2 only

Explanation: Statement 3 is incorrect. The famous Pushkar Fair (Pushkar Camel Fair) is located in the Ajmer district of Rajasthan, not Gujarat. It peaks around Kartik Poornima.

EXAM: SSC MTS 2022

Q33. Fact / Answer: 1, 2, and 3

Explanation: All statements are correct. Thrissur Pooram is Kerala's grandest temple festival featuring a massive parade of elephants and traditional percussion music, introduced by Sakthan Thampuran.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2020

Q34. Fact / Answer: 1 and 2 only

Explanation: Statement 3 is incorrect. Hampi Utsav commemorates the glory of the mighty Vijayanagara Empire, not the Chalukya empire.

EXAM: SSC CHSL 2022

Q35. Fact / Answer: 1, 2, and 3

Explanation: All statements are true. Gudi Padwa is the Marathi and Konkani New Year, celebrated on Chaitra Shukla Pratipada. A Gudi (flag topped with a copper/silver pot) is hoisted outside homes.

EXAM: SSC CPO 2021

Q36. Fact / Answer: 2 and 3 only

Explanation: Statement 1 is technically incorrect. Chapchar Kut is a Spring festival celebrated in March after the arduous task of clearing jungles (Jhum cultivation), not a harvest festival (Mim Kut is harvest). Cheraw (bamboo dance) is prominent.

EXAM: SSC CGL TIER-II 2020

Q37. Fact / Answer: 1, 2, and 3

Explanation: All statements are correct. Majuli is the world's largest river island located on the Brahmaputra in Assam. The festival beautifully showcases the Neo-Vaishnavite culture introduced by Srimanta Sankardeva.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2022

Q38. Fact / Answer: 1 and 2 only

Explanation: Statement 3 is incorrect. Bathukamma is a floral festival of Telangana but it coincides with the festival of Navratri (specifically starting on Mahalaya Amavasya), not Maha Shivaratri.

EXAM: SSC MTS 2021

Part 4: Incorrect Statements (Q39 - Q50)

Q39. Fact / Answer: Incorrect: It is celebrated primarily in Andhra Pradesh.

Explanation: Pongal is the most prominent multi-day harvest festival of Tamil Nadu, not Andhra Pradesh (though Makar Sankranti is celebrated there).

EXAM: SSC CGL 2021

Q40. Fact / Answer: Incorrect: It involves the worship of the river Ganga.

Explanation: Lohri involves a sacred bonfire and the worship of Agni (fire) and the Sun God. It does not involve the worship of the river Ganga.

EXAM: SSC CHSL 2020

Q41. Fact / Answer: Incorrect: It was introduced in India by the Mughal Emperor Akbar.

Explanation: Navroz (Persian New Year) was introduced in India by the Delhi Sultanate ruler Ghiyasuddin Balban, much earlier than the Mughal era.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2022

Q42. Fact / Answer: Incorrect: It is typically held during the peak of winter.

Explanation: The Hemis Festival in Ladakh is actually celebrated during the summer months, typically in June or July.

EXAM: SSC CPO 2022

Q43. Fact / Answer: Incorrect: It features traditional camel races as a main event.

Explanation: Saga Dawa is a highly sacred Buddhist festival in Sikkim. Camel races are associated with the Pushkar Fair in Rajasthan, completely unrelated to Saga Dawa.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2023

Q44. Fact / Answer: Incorrect: It is strictly held during the Holi festival.

Explanation: Sonapur Mela, the famous cattle fair in Bihar, begins on Kartik Poornima (November/December), not during Holi (which is in March).

EXAM: SSC MTS 2022

Q45. Fact / Answer: Incorrect: Devotees conventionally pierce their bodies with hooks and spears.

Explanation: Body piercing with hooks/spears is a prominent ritual in the Tamil festival of Thaipusam. Bonalu in Telangana involves carrying earthen pots with meals as an offering to Goddess Mahakali.

EXAM: SSC CGL TIER-II 2021

Q46. Fact / Answer: Incorrect: The festival begins in the peak of summer.

Explanation: Rann Utsav in the white salt desert of Kutch, Gujarat is a winter festival that typically runs from November to February.

EXAM: SSC CHSL 2022

Q47. Fact / Answer: Incorrect: It is primarily dedicated to Lord Krishna.

Explanation: Makaravilakku is a highly revered festival held at the Sabarimala shrine in Kerala, completely dedicated to Lord Ayyappa, not Lord Krishna.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2020

Q48. Fact / Answer: Incorrect: It essentially marks the beginning of the winter season.

Explanation: Moatsu Mong is celebrated by the Ao tribe in Nagaland in May, right after the seeds are sown. It marks the start of the summer/agricultural growing season, not winter.

EXAM: SSC CPO 2021

Q49. Fact / Answer: Incorrect: It primarily celebrates the birth of Lord Krishna.

Explanation: The Tarnetar Fair in Gujarat is historically linked to the Swayamvar of Draupadi (from the Mahabharata) and is centered around the Trinetreshwar Mahadev (Shiva) temple.

EXAM: SSC CGL 2022

Q50. Fact / Answer: Incorrect: It is held annually without a gap year.

Explanation: Sammakka Sarakka (Medaram) Jatara in Telangana is a massive biennial festival. It is celebrated once every two years, not annually.

EXAM: SSC MTS 2021